



halid let the silence settle between them. Sometimes, silence carried lessons that words could not. After a while, he looked up at the moon.

“Zayd... Do you remember the story of Prophet Adam, peace be upon him?”

Zayd smiled a little. “The first man.”

Khalid nodded. “Yes.”

For a moment, neither of them spoke.

Only the sounds of the of a busy night life filled the night.

Then Khalid asked softly,

“Do you remember why Iblis refused to bow?”

Zayd thought carefully. “...because he thought he was better.”

Khalid smiled. “Exactly.”

“But do you remember why he thought he was better?”

Zayd looked up at the moon again. “I think...”

“He said he was made from fire.”

“And Adam was made from clay.”

Khalid placed his hand gently on Zayd’s shoulder.

“That’s right.”

“And that, my son...”

“...is where one of the greatest mistakes in history began.”